

PROBITY: CONCEPT AND PHILOSOPHICAL BASIS OF GOVERNANCE

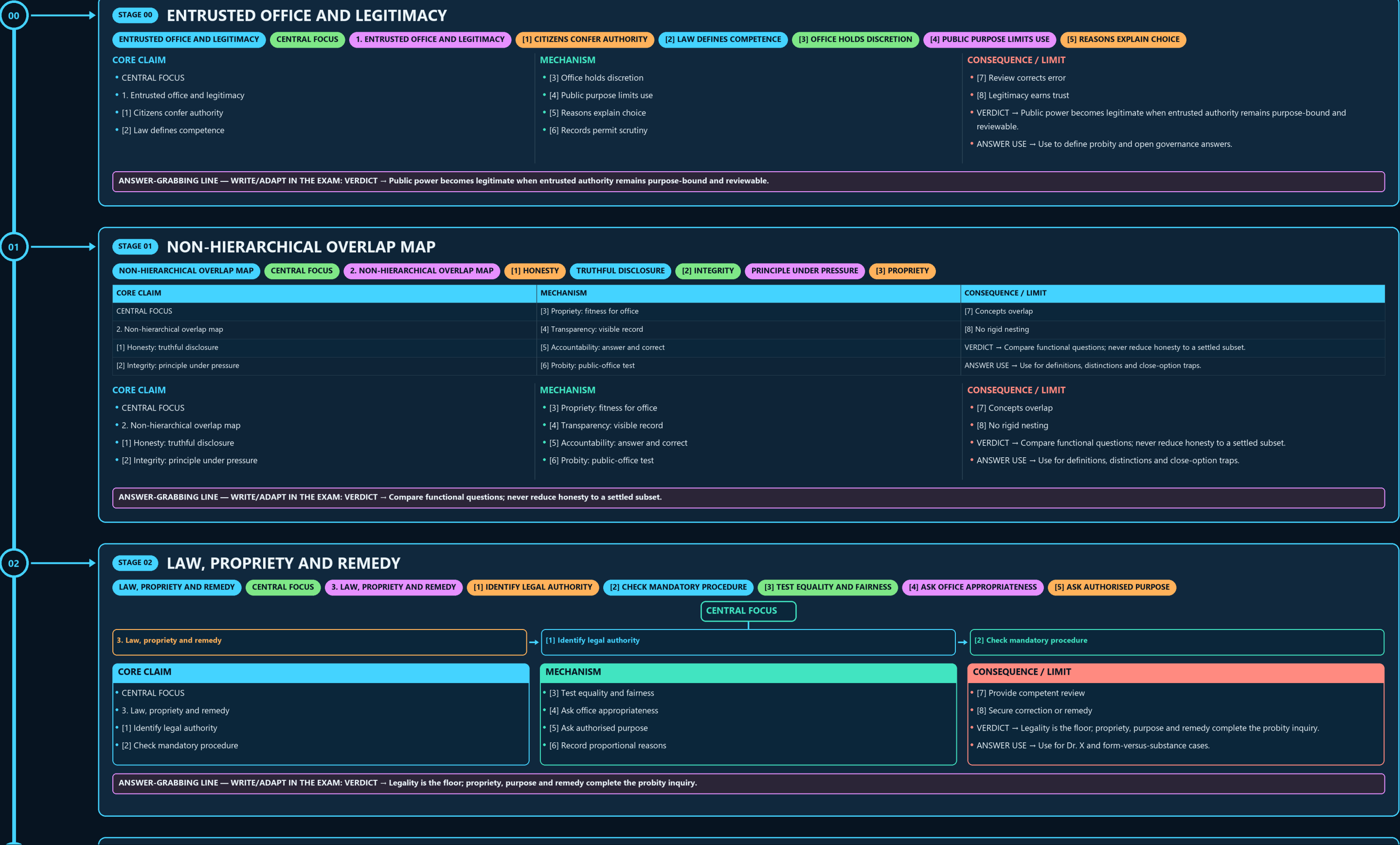
ENTRUSTED OFFICE AND LEGITIMACY → NON-HIERARCHICAL OVERLAP MAP → LAW, PROPRIETY AND REMEDY → CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE → HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK → DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g1 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- [8] Secure correction or remedy
- VERDICT → Legality is the floor; propriety, purpose and remedy complete the probity inquiry.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Dr. X and form-versus-substance cases.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Legality is the floor; propriety, purpose and remedy complete the probity inquiry.

CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE CENTRAL FOCUS 4. CONFLICT AND RECUSAL ROUTE [1] IDENTIFY PRIVATE INTEREST [2] ASSESS MATERIAL CONNECTION [3] DISCLOSE BEFORE DECISION [4] STOP INFORMAL CONTACT [5] RECUSE WHEN IMPARTIALITY RISKS

→ [2] Assess material connection

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Preserve decision record
- [8] Review appearance and outcome
- VERDICT → Private confidence in fairness cannot replace institutional conflict control.
- ANSWER USE → Use for procurement, licensing and appointment cases.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Private confidence in fairness cannot replace institutional conflict control.

HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK	CENTRAL FOCUS	S. HIGH-DISCRETION CONTROL STACK	[1] GRADE VALUE AND HARM	[2] PUBLISH OBJECTIVE CRITERIA	[3] GIVE EQUAL INFORMATION	[4] SEPARATE DECISION ROLES	[5] RECORD CONFLICTS AND RECUSALS
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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Use focused audit
- [8] Keep appeal and remedy
- VERDICT → Controls should intensify with discretion, value and foreseeable harm.
- ANSWER USE → Use for land, licensing and specialised procurement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Controls should intensify with discretion, value and foreseeable harm.

DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY CENTRAL FOCUS 6. DEONTOLOGY AND CONSTITUTIONAL MORALITY [1] DUTY BINDS DESPITE DETECTION [2] PERSONS ARE NOT MERE MEANS [3] OFFICE LIMITS PRIVATE GAIN [4] CONSTITUTION SUPPLIES VALUES [5] EQUALITY DISCIPLINES CHOICE

→ [3] Office limits private gain

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Review restrains power
- [8] Public reason joins both
- VERDICT → Duty sets moral limits; constitutional morality gives them public institutional form.
- ANSWER USE → Use for philosophical-basis and 2019/2025 PYQs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Duty sets moral limits; constitutional morality gives them public institutional form.

VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS CENTRAL FOCUS 7. VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS [1] PRACTICE TRUTHFUL CONDUCT [2] BUILD STABLE INTEGRITY [3] CULTIVATE COURAGE [4] CULTIVATE JUSTICE [5] READ CONTEXT CAREFULLY

→ [2] Build stable integrity

06

STAGE 06 VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS

VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS CENTRAL FOCUS 7. VIRTUE AND PHRONESIS [1] PRACTICE TRUTHFUL CONDUCT [2] BUILD STABLE INTEGRITY [3] CULTIVATE COURAGE [4] CULTIVATE JUSTICE [5] READ CONTEXT CAREFULLY

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Virtue and phronesis

[1] Practice truthful conduct

[2] Build stable integrity

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 7. Virtue and phronesis
- [1] Practice truthful conduct
- [2] Build stable integrity

MECHANISM

- [3] Cultivate courage
- [4] Cultivate justice
- [5] Read context carefully
- [6] Balance relevant duties

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Choose proportionate means
- [8] Accept public verification
- VERDICT → Practical wisdom applies stable virtue without abandoning reasons or institutions.
- ANSWER USE → Use when rules leave lawful discretion.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Practical wisdom applies stable virtue without abandoning reasons or institutions.

07

STAGE 07 TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY

TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY CENTRAL FOCUS 8. TRUSTEESHIP BOUNDARY [1] AUTHORITY COMES FROM CITIZENS [2] OFFICE IS NOT PROPERTY [3] GANDHI POWER AS STEWARDSHIP [4] MEANS MUST FIT ENDS

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Trusteeship boundary

[1] Authority comes from citizens

[2] Office is not property

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 8. Trusteeship boundary
- [1] Authority comes from citizens
- [2] Office is not property

MECHANISM

- [3] Gandhi: power as stewardship
- [4] Means must fit ends
- [5] Public-office trust is analogy
- [6] Natural-resource doctrine is settled

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] M.C. Mehta boundary retained
- [8] Specific law still controls
- VERDICT → Use trusteeship philosophically, not as a universal environmental-doctrine holding.
- ANSWER USE → Use to gain sophistication without legal overclaiming.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Use trusteeship philosophically, not as a universal environmental-doctrine holding.

08

STAGE 08 PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT

PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT CENTRAL FOCUS 9. PROCUREMENT INTEGRITY PACT [1] INCORPORATE PACT IN BID [2] BUYER REJECTS CORRUPT INFLUENCE [3] SELLERS REJECT BRIBERY [4] SELLERS REJECT COLLUSION [5] PROTECT ELECTRONIC INFORMATION

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 9. Procurement Integrity Pact
- [1] Incorporate pact in bid
- [2] Buyer rejects corrupt influence

MECHANISM

- [3] Sellers reject bribery
- [4] Sellers reject collusion
- [5] Protect electronic information
- [6] Treat bidders equitably

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Report vigilance concerns
- [8] Retain other safeguards
- VERDICT → The Pact is an incorporated preventive control, not proof of guilt or a complete regime.
- ANSWER USE → Use with GeM bid document 9511605.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → The Pact is an incorporated preventive control, not proof of guilt or a complete regime.

09

STAGE 09 ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS

ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS CENTRAL FOCUS 10. ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS [1] RPA S75A ELECTED MP [2] FILE WITHIN 90 DAYS OF OATH [3] NOT AN ANNUAL RPA RETURN [4] CCS RULE 18

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Asset-disclosure distinctions
- [1] RPA s75A: elected MP
- [2] File within 90 days of oath

MECHANISM

- [3] Not an annual RPA return
- [4] CCS Rule 18: service regime
- [5] AIS Rule 16: separate regime
- [6] Annual property returns differ

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Lokpal s44 text substituted
- [8] No universal online claim
- VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Prelims traps and probity mechanisms.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS

MECHANISM

- [3] Not an annual RPA return

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Lokpal s44 text substituted

ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. ASSET-DISCLOSURE DISTINCTIONS

[1] RPA S75A

ELECTED MP

[2] FILE WITHIN 90 DAYS OF OATH

[3] NOT AN ANNUAL RPA RETURN

[4] CCS RULE 18

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CENTRAL FOCUS	[3] Not an annual RPA return	[7] Lokpal s44 text substituted
10. Asset-disclosure distinctions	[4] CCS Rule 18: service regime	[8] No universal online claim
[1] RPA s75A: elected MP	[5] AIS Rule 16: separate regime	VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.
[2] File within 90 days of oath	[6] Annual property returns differ	ANSWER USE → Use for Prelims traps and probity mechanisms.

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 10. Asset-disclosure distinctions
- [1] RPA s75A: elected MP
- [2] File within 90 days of oath

MECHANISM

- [3] Not an annual RPA return
- [4] CCS Rule 18: service regime
- [5] AIS Rule 16: separate regime
- [6] Annual property returns differ

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Lokpal s44 text substituted
- [8] No universal online claim
- VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.
- ANSWER USE → Use for Prelims traps and probity mechanisms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → State the population, timing and legal source of each disclosure duty separately.

10

STAGE 10

RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT

RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. RTI, AUDIT AND SOCIAL AUDIT

[1] RECORDS MAKE ACTION VISIBLE

[2] RTI ENABLES LAWFUL ACCESS

[3] DEPARTMENTAL AUDIT CHECKS SYSTEMS

[4] CAG ACTS WITHIN MANDATE

[5] CVC OVERSEES VIGILANCE

CENTRAL FOCUS

→

11. RTI, audit and social audit

→

[1] Records make action visible

→

[2] RTI enables lawful access

→

[3] Departmental audit checks systems

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 11. RTI, audit and social audit
- [1] Records make action visible
- [2] RTI enables lawful access

MECHANISM

- [3] Departmental audit checks systems
- [4] CAG acts within mandate
- [5] CVC oversees vigilance
- [6] CVO coordinates departments

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Citizens verify lived delivery
- [8] Follow-up supplies accountability
- VERDICT → No single institution replaces financial, vigilance, citizen and remedial scrutiny.
- ANSWER USE → Use for 2021 social-audit and transparency answers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → No single institution replaces financial, vigilance, citizen and remedial scrutiny.

11

STAGE 11

BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW

BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. BONA FIDES AND PROPORTIONATE REVIEW

[1] VERIFY AUTHORITY AND FACTS

[2] DISCLOSE MATERIAL INTERESTS

[3] CONSIDER REASONABLE ALTERNATIVES

[4] RECORD CONTEMPORANEOUS REASONS

[5] PROTECT HONEST RISK-TAKING

CENTRAL FOCUS

→

12. Bona fides and proportionate review

→

[1] Verify authority and facts

→

[2] Disclose material interests

→

[3] Consider reasonable alternatives

CORE CLAIM

- CENTRAL FOCUS
- 12. Bona fides and proportionate review
- [1] Verify authority and facts
- [2] Disclose material interests

MECHANISM

- [3] Consider reasonable alternatives
- [4] Record contemporaneous reasons
- [5] Protect honest risk-taking
- [6] Review without outcome bias

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- [7] Correct proven error
- [8] Remedy supported harm
- VERDICT → Good-faith protection blocks hindsight punishment, not evidence, review or remedy.
- ANSWER USE → Use as the final advanced answer and case-study test.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Good-faith protection blocks hindsight punishment, not evidence, review or remedy.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. ARCHITECTURE

2. CONCEPTS AND DISTINCTIONS

3. DETAILED TREATMENT

4. INSTITUTIONAL AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE

5. INDIAN APPLICATIONS AND BOUNDARY CASES

6. LIMITATIONS AND TRADE-OFFS

7. MUST-KNOW FACTS FOR ADVANCED PRELIMS

OPTIONAL ETHICAL DEPTH

- 1. Architecture
- 2. Concepts and distinctions
- 3. Detailed treatment
- 4. Institutional and reform architecture

ADVANCED LIMIT / TRADE-OFF

- 5. Indian applications and boundary cases
- 6. Limitations and trade-offs
- 7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims
- 8. Advanced Prelims traps

ADMINISTRATIVE APPLICATION

- 9. Current application
- 10. PYQ-based analytical application
- 11. Mains-ready framework
- 12. Probable questions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.